

# **Minorian Reference Phonology**

# Consonant Inventory

|                  | Bilabial | Dental | Alveolar | Post-Alveolar | Retroflex | Palatal | Velar | Uvular | Glottal |
|------------------|----------|--------|----------|---------------|-----------|---------|-------|--------|---------|
| <b>Plosive</b>   | p b      |        | t d      |               |           |         | k g   | q ɢ    |         |
| <b>Fricative</b> | ɸ (β)    | θ (ð)  | s z      | ʃ             |           |         | x (ɣ) | χ (ʁ)  | (h)     |
| <b>Affricate</b> |          |        |          | tʃ            |           |         |       |        |         |
| <b>Nasal</b>     | m        |        | n        |               |           | ɲ       | ŋ     | (ɴ)    |         |
| <b>Lateral</b>   |          |        | l        |               |           |         |       |        |         |
| <b>Trill</b>     |          |        | r        |               |           |         |       |        |         |
| <b>Liquid</b>    | w        |        |          | (ɭ)           | j         | (w)     |       |        |         |

## Notes

- All voiceless plosives are aspirated except when following /s/.
- All voiced plosives become spirantized when between voiced sonorants or vowels.
- All non-sibilant fricatives become voiced at the end of a word when following a vowel.
- /r/ becomes [ɻ] in coda positions immediately following vowels.
- /r/, /ɻ/ may be tapped when not geminated.
- /x/ becomes [h] in onset positions.
- Some speakers retract /ɸ/ and [β] to [f] and [v], respectively.
- /ŋ/ becomes [ɴ] before uvular stops

# Vowel Inventory

|                   | Front             |       | Central | Back  |      |
|-------------------|-------------------|-------|---------|-------|------|
|                   | Short             | Long  |         | Short | Long |
| <b>Close</b>      | i y               | i: y: |         | u     | u:   |
| <b>Near Close</b> | (ɪ)               |       |         | (ʊ)   |      |
| <b>Close-Mid</b>  | e (ø)             | e: ø: | ə       | (o)   | o:   |
| <b>Mid</b>        | (ɐ)               |       | ə       |       |      |
| <b>Open-Mid</b>   | (ɛ) (œ)           | ɛ: œ: |         | (ɔ)   | ɔ:   |
| <b>Open</b>       | æ                 | æ:    | (a)     | ɑ     | ɑ:   |
| <b>Nasal</b>      | æ̃                | æ̃:   | ã       | ã     | ã:   |
| <b>Diphthongs</b> | aɪ eɪ ɔɪ eɪ ɔɪ ɔɪ |       |         |       |      |

## Notes

- All short unrounded plain vowels and /ɛ:/ become /ə/ in unstressed syllables, except for /i/, which becomes [ɪ].
- All short nasal vowels become /ẽ/ in unstressed syllables.
- All short rounded vowels and /ø:/, /o:/, /œ:/, /ɔ:/ become /ə/ in unstressed syllables.
- All nasal vowels may become closer to mid-height depending on the speaker.
- All long vowels become short in unstressed syllables.
- Some speakers may pronounce /ɑ/, /e/, /u/ as [a], [ɐ], [ʊ]

# Phonotactics

The maximum syllable structure of Minorian is  $(C)^3V(C)^5$  when analyzed without syllabic consonants and  $(C)^3V(C)^3$  when analyzed with syllabic consonants. The following section will use the former analysis

## Syllable-Level Rules

### Onset

- **Null Onset**
- **Single Onset**
  - Any consonant that isn't /ŋ/;
- **Double Onset**
  - Any plosive or fricative (besides /x/ and /χ/) + /l/, /r/, or /j/ with the exception of the cluster /kj/;
  - Any voiceless plosive or fricative (besides /x/ and /χ/) + /ŋ/, /ŋ/, or /ŋ/ with the exception of the clusters /pŋ/ and /tŋ/;
  - Any plosive or fricative (besides /x/) + /m/, /n/, or /ɲ/ with the exception of the clusters /bm/, /pm/, /dn/, and /tn/;
  - Any plosive or fricative (besides /b/, /p/, /q/, /g/, and /χ/) + /w/;
  - /s/ + any voiceless plosive;
- **Triple Onset**
  - /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ or /q/), /ϕ/, or /θ/ + /r/.

### Nucleus

- Any vowel can serve as the nucleus of a syllable;
- **Restrictions**
  - Nasal vowels cannot occur in syllables where the first consonant of the coda was a nasal consonant.
  - /i/ and /i:/ cannot occur in syllables that had /ɲ/ in their onsets.

### Coda

- **Null Coda**
- **Single Coda**
  - Any consonant;
- **Double Coda**
  - /l/ or /r/ + any plosive or fricative;
  - /m/ or /n/ + any plosive with the exception of the clusters /mb/, /nd/, /nk/, /ng/, /nq/, and /ng/;

- /ŋ/ or /ŋ/ + any voiceless plosive with the exception of the clusters /ŋp/ and /ŋt/;
- /ŋ/ + /k/ or /q/;
- /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ and /q/);
- /f/ + any voiceless stop or plosive;
- /b/ + /n/ or /ɲ/;

- **Triple Coda**

- /f/ + /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ and /q/).

## Word-Level Rules

### Word-Initial

- **Restrictions**

- /z/ may not be present word-initially.

### Word-Medial

- Most clusters, including geminates, are allowed;

- **Restrictions**

- Hiatus is not allowed;
- No /sp/ or /st/ + /sp/, /st/, /sθ/, /sθ/, or /j/;
- No clusters involving voiceless sonorants unless said clusters are geminates;
- No geminates that aren't between vowels;
- No /n/ + velar or uvular stops;
- No velar-uvular or uvular-velar consonant clusters;
- No clusters involving /ɲ/ unless said cluster is geminated /ɲ/;
- No clusters involving two distinct sibilants in contact with each other (e.g. no /sz/, /zs/, /ʃs/ &c.);
- No /bm/, /pm/, /dn/, /tn/, /mb/, /nd/, /mp/, /nt/;
- No mixed-voice clusters of plosives, fricatives, or both (e.g. no /sb/, /dsθ/ &c.).

### Word-Finally

- Any combination of a coda and onset is allowed to occur as a word-final consonant cluster (you can thank high-vowel apocope for leading to such monstrosities as /fpsθr/) except those that violate the word-medial restrictions (e.g. no word-final clusters like /zsθr/) and clusters ending in /j/ or /w/. This is where the (C)<sup>5</sup> in the syllable structure analysis comes from.

# Romanization

Obviously, I'm not gonna write everything using the International Phonetic Alphabet because it's very ugly. Here is a table of letter-to-sound correspondences

| Letter | Phoneme |
|--------|---------|
| a      | /ɑ/     |
| aa     | /ɑ:/    |
| ae     | /ɑæ/    |
| ã      | /ã/     |
| ãa     | /ã:/    |
| ä      | /æ/     |
| äa     | /æ:/    |
| ẽa     | /ẽ/     |
| ãä     | /ẽ:/    |
| b      | /b/     |
| ch     | /tʃ/    |
| d      | /d/     |
| e      | /e/     |
| ee     | /e:/    |
| ẽ      | /ẽ/     |
| ê      | /ɛ:/    |
| eo     | /eq/    |
| eeo    | /e:q/   |
| f      | /f/     |
| g      | /g/     |
| hm     | /ŋ/     |
| hn     | /ŋ/     |

|     |        |
|-----|--------|
| hny | /ɲ/    |
| hl  | /l̥/   |
| hr  | /r̥/   |
| i   | /i/    |
| ii  | /iː/   |
| j   | /j/    |
| k   | /k/    |
| l   | /l/    |
| m   | /m/    |
| n   | /n/    |
| ny  | /ɲ/    |
| o   | /ɔː/   |
| ô   | /oː/   |
| ö   | /e/    |
| ö   | /øː/   |
| ø   | /œː/   |
| oi  | /ɔːi̯/ |
| p   | /p/    |
| q   | /q/    |
| qg  | /ɣ/    |
| qh  | /χ/    |
| r   | /r/    |
| s   | /s/    |
| sh  | /ʃ/    |
| t   | /t/    |
| þ   | /θ/    |

|    |      |
|----|------|
| u  | /u/  |
| uu | /u:/ |
| ü  | /y/  |
| üu | /y:/ |
| w  | /w/  |
| x  | /x/  |
| z  | /z/  |

## Diacritics

Diacritics are used to clear up ambiguity and make things look a little nicer. The romanization of Minorian uses one diacritic, whose function is listed in the table below.

| Diacritic | Function                                                   |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| ◌̃        | Marks gemination on a multigraph (e.g. šh represents /ʃ:/) |

## Stress and Prosody

Minorian has both lexical and prosodic stress. The primary stress of a word falls on the first syllable of said word. Secondary stresses fall on the third, fifth, seventh, &c. syllables. Prosodic stress usually falls on the last word of a prosodic phrase, though it could fall elsewhere for emphasis. Prosodic phrases are usually separated by pauses in speech and usually constituted single clauses.